

development.

“ The **poor little fellow** plays marvelously,
he is a child of **spirit, lively, charming ...**
”

COUNT KARL VON ZINZENDORF, ON MOZART AT
AGE SIX, 1762

Back in Salzburg from late 1766, the family made another foray to Vienna only nine months later, again in search of elusive imperial patronage. The family’s constant journeying, mostly by coach on poor quality roads, was arduous and hazardous. Both of the children contracted serious illnesses, Wolfgang coming close to dying of rheumatic fever in 1767. Moreover, the costs of travel and lodging used up much of the money gained from public performances. But Leopold’s will and ambition were implacable—the second journey to Vienna had been undertaken despite a smallpox epidemic gripping the city.

Mozart’s last tours as a paraded prodigy were three circuits of Italy with his father between 1770 and 1773. The first was triumphant: he was made a member of the musical academy in Bologna; in Rome the pope created him a knight of the Golden Spur; and he wrote an Italian opera, *Mitridate, re di Ponto*, which was staged in Milan just before he turned 15. However, his second two visits to Italy were met with less enthusiasm; by 1773, he was simply too old to be marketed as a prodigy.